

日本プレス掲載

the japan times

thejapantimes

A California wildfire survivor turns devastation into art with a message on the climate crisis



Alexandre M. Lopez brings his wildfire wildfire experience to his artwork, which depicts the devastation, emotional, climate change, and the impact on the environment.

BY TOMOYO DAIKE
Staff Writer
10/20/2024 10:00 AM
10/20/2024 10:00 AM

Listen to this article

thejapantimes



Alexandre M. Lopez captures a fire on his canvas from his wildfire (10/20/2024) at the Los Angeles County Art Center.

Lopez's preferred mode of creation is on-site, on outdoor painting. For this, he goes into the wilderness to capture the energy and emotions of the scene. He also brings his own materials, such as wood, stone, and paper, which he uses to create his artwork.

"It was absolutely overwhelming to me. And the only way I could try to deal with it was to paint," Lopez said during a talk at the Los Angeles County Art Center.

After a wildfire that affected his hometown of Los Angeles, Lopez's art is a powerful statement on the impact of the wildfire that erupted in Los Angeles County's Eaton Canyon.

thejapantimes

When artist Alexandre M. Lopez saw his home and those of thousands of others in California engulfed in flames in January 2023, he was overwhelmed with horror and fear. He also felt an urgent need to act — and an urge to create.

"It was absolutely overwhelming to me. And the only way I could try to deal with it was to paint," Lopez said during a talk at the Los Angeles County Art Center.

After a wildfire that affected his hometown of Los Angeles, Lopez's art is a powerful statement on the impact of the wildfire that erupted in Los Angeles County's Eaton Canyon.

thejapantimes

Lopez's preferred mode of creation is on-site, on outdoor painting. For this, he goes into the wilderness to capture the energy and emotions of the scene. He also brings his own materials, such as wood, stone, and paper, which he uses to create his artwork.

"It was absolutely overwhelming to me. And the only way I could try to deal with it was to paint," Lopez said during a talk at the Los Angeles County Art Center.

After a wildfire that affected his hometown of Los Angeles, Lopez's art is a powerful statement on the impact of the wildfire that erupted in Los Angeles County's Eaton Canyon.

thejapantimes

For "Tsunami," the first of the three series comprising his "At the San Jose" exhibition, he painted from a location outside Alameda where he and his family evacuated each day after attempting to protect their home from the flames.

One painting in this series depicts a tree from within its trunk and branches glowing like Christmas lights, as Lopez describes them.

thejapantimes

Memory becomes physical in "Pages," which includes a book page Lopez collected in the aftermath of the fire. The page had flames rising to the sky and drifted back down without burning — a cruel sight given that the fire was not enough to melt metal.

After sharing his art with the Alameda community, Lopez has taken on a new role to act as a messenger rather than remain solely a victim — and survivor — of climate change.

Scientists concluded that the hot, dry and windy conditions during the two major LA fires — the Palmdale and Eaton fires — were made more intense and 35% more likely because of climate change, WUOL said.

thejapantimes

The final series, "Hope in the Face of What," draws inspiration from signs of renewal. Lopez spotted snail the devastation — fresh leaves sprouting from blackened trunks and flowers blooming in vibrant color across an otherwise monochrome expanse of charcoal and ash. The leaves, crocuses, poppies, tulips and lilies are small.

"It was nature rebounding in ways I couldn't imagine," he said. "What stood as devastation and trauma and a sense of helplessness and loss, but through this I found a sense of hope."

After sharing his art with the Alameda community, Lopez has taken on a new role to act as a messenger rather than remain solely a victim — and survivor — of climate change.

Scientists concluded that the hot, dry and windy conditions during the two major LA fires — the Palmdale and Eaton fires — were made more intense and 35% more likely because of climate change, WUOL said.

thejapantimes

The final series, "Hope in the Face of What," draws inspiration from signs of renewal. Lopez spotted snail the devastation — fresh leaves sprouting from blackened trunks and flowers blooming in vibrant color across an otherwise monochrome expanse of charcoal and ash. The leaves, crocuses, poppies, tulips and lilies are small.

"It was nature rebounding in ways I couldn't imagine," he said. "What stood as devastation and trauma and a sense of helplessness and loss, but through this I found a sense of hope."

After sharing his art with the Alameda community, Lopez has taken on a new role to act as a messenger rather than remain solely a victim — and survivor — of climate change.

Scientists concluded that the hot, dry and windy conditions during the two major LA fires — the Palmdale and Eaton fires — were made more intense and 35% more likely because of climate change, WUOL said.

thejapantimes

"The reason that I brought this collection to Japan was to start to have this discussion and to see (whether) it resonates with people away from the fire areas," he said.

Deanne Ford, a curator at the Ullrichsperfer Kuno, said Lopez's art and firsthand accounts bring the impact of climate change closer to people.

"Creating a space where these topics can be spoken about frankly, in a more intimate setting where people feel they can engage with the subject, has a greater chance of creating a more impact of change," she said.

Ortensia Fernandez Gonzalez, a Venezuelan graduate student and master student in Tokyo, said the exhibition left a strong impression.

"I came here with no expectations at all, but I'm in shock and I'm moved," she said. "The raw value of this exhibition is... I've not only shared the trauma, but also the rebirth."

"At the San Jose" by Alexandre M. Lopez runs until Feb. 27 at the Ullrichsperfer Kuno Gallery at 2-4-18 Higashi, Shinjuku Ward, Tokyo. Visitors need to book a ticket.

thejapantimes

Deanne Ford, a curator at the Ullrichsperfer Kuno, said Lopez's art and firsthand accounts bring the impact of climate change closer to people.

"Creating a space where these topics can be spoken about frankly, in a more intimate setting where people feel they can engage with the subject, has a greater chance of creating a more impact of change," she said.

Ortensia Fernandez Gonzalez, a Venezuelan graduate student and master student in Tokyo, said the exhibition left a strong impression.

"I came here with no expectations at all, but I'm in shock and I'm moved," she said. "The raw value of this exhibition is... I've not only shared the trauma, but also the rebirth."

"At the San Jose" by Alexandre M. Lopez runs until Feb. 27 at the Ullrichsperfer Kuno Gallery at 2-4-18 Higashi, Shinjuku Ward, Tokyo. Visitors need to book a ticket.

thejapantimes

Jakaichi touts responsibility of fiscal policy



Jakaichi members in traditional attire.

thejapantimes

life & culture

A wildfire survivor turns devastation into art



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

mixmag

mixmag

Alexandre M. Lopez: 「自然を愛し、自然を守ることは、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。」

自然との関係: Alexandre M. Lopezの作品、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

mixmag

Alexandre M. Lopez: 「自然を愛し、自然を守ることは、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。」

自然との関係: Alexandre M. Lopezの作品、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

mixmag

Alexandre M. Lopez: 「自然を愛し、自然を守ることは、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。」

自然との関係: Alexandre M. Lopezの作品、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

mixmag

Alexandre M. Lopez: 「自然を愛し、自然を守ることは、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。」

自然との関係: Alexandre M. Lopezの作品、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

mixmag

Alexandre M. Lopez: 「自然を愛し、自然を守ることは、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。」

自然との関係: Alexandre M. Lopezの作品、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

mixmag

Alexandre M. Lopez: 「自然を愛し、自然を守ることは、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。」

自然との関係: Alexandre M. Lopezの作品、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

mixmag

Alexandre M. Lopez: 「自然を愛し、自然を守ることは、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。」

自然との関係: Alexandre M. Lopezの作品、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

mixmag

Alexandre M. Lopez: 「自然を愛し、自然を守ることは、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。」

自然との関係: Alexandre M. Lopezの作品、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

mixmag

Alexandre M. Lopez: 「自然を愛し、自然を守ることは、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。」

自然との関係: Alexandre M. Lopezの作品、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

mixmag

Alexandre M. Lopez: 「自然を愛し、自然を守ることは、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。」

自然との関係: Alexandre M. Lopezの作品、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

mixmag

Alexandre M. Lopez: 「自然を愛し、自然を守ることは、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。」

自然との関係: Alexandre M. Lopezの作品、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

mixmag

Alexandre M. Lopez: 「自然を愛し、自然を守ることは、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。」

自然との関係: Alexandre M. Lopezの作品、自然の恵みを愛し、自然を守ることに尽きます。



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

GQ

GQ

REN MEGURO
自然を愛する
アーティストの
アートワーク



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

GQ

自然を愛する
アーティストの
アートワーク



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

GQ

自然を愛する
アーティストの
アートワーク



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

GQ

自然を愛する
アーティストの
アートワーク



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

GQ

自然を愛する
アーティストの
アートワーク



A painting of a tree with a fire running through its branches.

Japan Press Coverage 2026-2024

Japan Times

Mix Mag Japan

GQ Japan

Marie Claire

“ONE WITH NATURE” SPEAKING EVENTS

As an Environmental Artist / Activist I am committed through my art practice to engage audiences around the world in discussion and shared experiences of how we can connect with the interbeing nature of our world through physical interaction and presence in our natural world.

